

Bob Enterprise Subscription – User Onboarding Request

Created by [Brooke Jones](#) on Mon, 04/27/2026 - 13:38
Published URL: <https://www.ibm.com/support/pages/node/7270891>

White Papers

Abstract

This document defines the onboarding request process for Bob Enterprise subscriptions, clarifying the differences between TechZone managed access and dedicated instances. It guides requesters to the simplest viable option, sets expectations for lead time and justification, and standardizes required information to speed approvals and provisioning while reducing unnecessary dedicated account requests.

Content

Purpose

This document explains the user onboarding request process for Bob Enterprise subscriptions. Its goals are to:

- Clearly distinguish request types to reduce confusion and routing delays
- Require explicit justification when a trial or TechZone managed account cannot be used
- Educate requesters on the differences between Dedicated Instance and TechZone Managed access
- Collect complete and consistent information upfront to accelerate approvals and provisioning
- Splitting request types has proven effective in guiding users toward the simplest viable option and reducing unnecessary dedicated account requests.

Overview of Access Models

1. TechZone Managed Account (Enterprise – User Access)

- Lead-time expectations: Faster provisioning
- Centrally managed by TechZone
- Provides user-level access only
- Supports workshops, enablement sessions, demos, and most hands-on experiences
- Additional users must be added by TechZone
- Lower cost and operational overhead

Choose this option if you need Enterprise access for workshops, demos, or learning activities and do not require admin-level control.

2. Dedicated Instance (Enterprise – Admin Access)

- Lead-time expectations: Additional setup time (typically 1+ extra weeks)
- Fully dedicated Bob Enterprise subscription
- Provides admin-level access
- Higher cost and operational overhead

Choose this option only if your requirements cannot be met using a TechZone managed account or a trial.

Important Guidance for Requesters

General - Read Before Submitting

- **Trials and TechZone managed accounts should be the default**
- Dedicated instances require **clear, explicit justification**

If your primary need is “adding user X so I can run a workshop,” a **TechZone managed account is**

- **usually sufficient**

This request process is intentionally designed to guide requesters to the most appropriate access model

Policies - Read Before Submitting

To ensure limited resources are available for client engagements and to account for required manual setup steps, the following policies apply:

- A valid Opportunity ID is required for all requests. Education-only, test, or exploratory requests are not supported at this time. This policy helps conserve resources for active client and partner engagements
- Requests must be submitted at least 7 days in advance
- Request reviews typically take up to 5 business days
- Account provisioning may take an additional business day, as setup steps within the Bob product are currently manual

Important note on provisioning timelines:

The IBM Bob product team is aware that onboarding and provisioning currently require manual steps. The TechZone team has formally requested product enhancements, including APIs and automation, to improve setup speed and scalability.

Until automation is available, provisioning timelines may vary based on request volume and complexity. The TechZone team will continue to process requests as quickly as possible within these constraints.

If you would like to help accelerate improvements, please communicate the importance of APIs and automation to the IBM Bob product team. Increased visibility and advocacy help prioritize these enhancements.

Request Type A: Bob Enterprise Subscription – Dedicated Instance

Use this request only when admin access, account isolation, or advanced configuration is required.

Submission Instructions

Submit a custom support request including all of the following:

- Detailed justification explaining why a trial or TechZone managed account cannot be used
- Start Date
- End Date
- Your Organization (e.g., Global Sales, Client Engineering, Partner Ecosystem)
- Admin IBMID / Email
- Number of Seats
- Number of Bobcoins
- Must be requested in packs of 1,000
- Recommended: 50–100 coins per user
- Maximum: 200 coins per user per month
- Opportunity ID
- Client Name
- Brief description of the event or use case

Note: Dedicated instances require additional lead time and should be requested well in advance of the start date.

Request Type B: Bob Enterprise Subscription – TechZone Managed Account

This is the recommended option for workshops, enablement sessions, and most client-facing events.

Submission Instructions

Submit a custom support request including all of the following:

- Justification for requiring Enterprise access instead of a trial
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Start Date

- End Date
- Your Organization (e.g., Global Sales, Client Engineering, Partner Ecosystem)
- Admin IBMID / Email (TechZone contact responsible for user additions)
- Number of Seats
- Number of Bobcoins
- Must be requested in packs of 1,000
- Recommended: 50–100 coins per user
- Maximum: 200 coins per user per month

Opportunity ID

Client Name

Brief description of the event or use case

Partner Access Process

Partners cannot submit onboarding requests directly. All partner access must be sponsored by an IBM internal owner, typically from the Partner Ecosystem team.

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Partner Access via Dedicated Instance

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When a Dedicated Instance is approved:

- A Partner Ecosystem team member (or designated IBM sponsor) submits the onboarding request

After provisioning, the admin owner may:

- Invite partner users directly, or
- Manage partner access based on the engagement scope
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Appropriate when partners require:

Isolated environments

Admin-level workflows

- Longer-running or reusable subscriptions

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Partner Access via TechZone Managed Account

When using a TechZone managed account:

- A Partner Ecosystem team member (IBMer) submits the onboarding request
- The request must include a complete list of partner email addresses
- The Partner Ecosystem team provides the list to TechZone Support
- TechZone Support invites partners to the shared subscription
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Preferred for:

- Partner-led or partner-inclusive workshops
- Enablement sessions
- Short-term, event-based access

Note: Partner email lists should be finalized before the event to avoid delays.

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How to Make a Bob Enterprise Onboarding Request

All Bob Enterprise onboarding requests must be submitted through a **TechZone Support case**. This request option is available to **IBMers only**.

Partner Access Reminder

- **Partners cannot submit onboarding requests directly**
- Partners must work with their **IBM internal sponsor** (typically from Global Sales or Partner Ecosystem)
- The IBMer submits the request **on the partner’s behalf**
- Partner email lists must be complete and accurate to avoid onboarding delays

If you are a partner requesting Bob access, please coordinate with your IBM counterpart before the event and provide all emails for the request and any information as found in the requirements in the above section to provide justification and information for the request.

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Step 1: Review Access Models and Policies

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Before submitting a request, ensure you understand:

- The difference between **TechZone Managed Accounts** and **Dedicated Instances**
- That **trials and TechZone managed access are the default**
- That **Dedicated Instances require explicit justification**
- That a **valid Opportunity ID is required**
- That requests must be submitted **at least 7 days in advance**

Requests that do not meet these criteria may be delayed or denied.

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Step 2: Identify the Correct Request Type

Choose **one** of the following request types based on your needs:

Request Type A — Dedicated Instance (Enterprise – Admin Access)

Use only when admin-level access, isolation, or advanced configuration is required and **cannot** be met through a trial or TechZone managed account.

Request Type B — TechZone Managed Account (Enterprise – User Access)

The **recommended option** for workshops, enablement sessions, demos, and most client or partner engagements.

Selecting the correct request type helps reduce delays and avoids unnecessary provisioning overhead.

Step 3: Submit a TechZone Support Request

Submit a **custom support request** and include **all required fields** for your selected request type (as listed in Sections *Request Type A* or *Request Type B* above).

Incomplete requests may be returned for clarification and will extend processing time.

Tip: Be explicit and detailed in your justification, especially when requesting a Dedicated Instance.

Step 4: Reference Official Guidance (IBMers Only)

IBMers can access the full onboarding guide, examples, and submission guidance here:

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TechZone Collection – Bob Enterprise Onboarding: <https://techzone.ibm.com/collection/69bac0f2c5a26dc2f7881d2d> (<https://techzone.ibm.com/collection/69bac0f2c5a26dc2f7881d2d>)

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This collection walks through:

- Bob overview
- Bob positioning
- Bobathon for seller information
- Request submission flow
- Required justification examples

Summary Decision Guide

Requirement	Recommended Option
Workshops / demos / training	TechZone Managed Account
User-level access only	TechZone Managed Account

Admin-level control required	Dedicated Instance
• Faster provisioning needed	TechZone Managed Account
• Account isolation is mandatory	Dedicated Instance

Final Notes

Partner access must always be sponsored by an IBM internal owner

Clear justification and complete user lists reduce onboarding delays

When in doubt, **start with a TechZone managed request** and escalate only if requirements cannot be met

RequirementRecommended OptionWorkshops / demos / trainingTechZone Managed AccountUser-level access
onlyTechZone Managed AccountFaster provisioning requiredTechZone Managed AccountAdmin-level control
requiredDedicated InstanceAccount isolation mandatoryDedicated Instance

Final Notes

Partner access must always be sponsored by an IBM internal owner

Clear justification and complete user lists significantly reduce onboarding delays

When in doubt, start with a TechZone managed request and escalate only if requirements cannot be met

Document Information

More support for:
[IBM Technology Zone](https://www.ibm.com/mysupport/s/topic/OTO50000000IVqBGAW) (<https://www.ibm.com/mysupport/s/topic/OTO50000000IVqBGAW>)

Component:
Content

Document number:
7270891

Modified date:
07 May 2026